

Eddie Sawyer Quits As Phils Manager; Mauch Takes Over

PHILADELPHIA (AP)— Eddie Sawyer quit as manager of the Philadelphia Phillies today — on the eve of his club's second game of the 1960 National League baseball season.

Gene Mauch, now managing Minneapolis of the American Assn., was named to replace him.

"I just didn't want to manage," said 49-year-old Sawyer at a hastily-called news conference in owner Bob Carpenter's office at Connie Mack Stadium.

The Phils, last season's cellar club, hadn't been expected to go very far in the 1960 race. They lost the season opener at Cincinnati, 9-4, and meet Milwaukee tonight in the Philadelphia park's opening game.

This was the second time Sawyer quit as Phils manager during a season. He resigned in the middle of the 1952 season as the club floundered. Two years before his 1950 "Whiz Kids" copped the league pennant—the only one for the Phils in modern baseball.

Sawyer was asked when he decided to quit and replied that "this notion has been with me the past few weeks." He said that training camp incidents involving discipline of players and criticism by some players of his managerial tactics had nothing to do with his decision.

Sawyer has benched most of last years regulars in favor of untried rookies.

Carpenter, in prefacing the disclosure of the resignation, told newsmen that "I know that this is going to be a shock to you as much as it was to me."

Sawyer slapped \$100 fines on pitcher Jim Owens, infielder Joe Koppe and outfielder Bobby Gene Smith after they were involved in a fight with a bar patron at the club's Clearwater, Fla. training base. Sawyer also has been openly critical of some of the Phils' ballplayers and it was known there was some resentment against his public statements.

Carpenter said that Sawyer telephoned him last night to say he was quitting.

Mauch, 34, signed a two-year contract. He played as an infielder in the National League with Brooklyn, Pittsburgh, Chicago and the Milwaukee Braves. He also was connected the with Boston

Red Sox of the American League.

His managerial experience began in 1953 as a player-manager with Atlanta of the Southern Assn.

Mauch was not on hand at the news conference and was not expected to report to the club before early tomorrow. Coach Andy Cohen was to run the team tonight.

Sawyer said that he hoped to stay in baseball but that he doesn't want to manage any more, anywhere.

His resignation severed all connections with the Phillies. But Carpenter said the door was still open for him to take another position with the club.

General Manager John Quinn said Mauch played for him with the Braves and "I recommended him to Atlanta as a manager. He is a very aggressive fellow and I'm certain he'll do a great job."

Quinn said that before he contracted Mauch last night he obtained permission from Bucky Harris, General Manager of the Red Sox, who own Minneapolis.

Sawyer commented that the Phils present club is a young aggregation and "if some of the players improve as I think they should, the Phillies should do all right."



EDDIE SAWYER



GENE MAUCH